

the traditional mix cultivation of hills.

This system of mix cultivation was known as Barahnaza. It included crops like Mandua, Chaulai, Jhangora, Maize, Ogle, Kidney Beans, Gahat, Bhatt, Tor, Til Jakhiya and Bhangira.

This Barahnaza system of cultivation was considered to be beneficial for inclusion of nutritious elements and for crop security also. It's residues were very useful for feeding the animals and it also used to help in keeping the land fertile.

MANDUA IS A SUPER FOOD OF UTTARAKHAND

The Mandua of Uttarakhand is considered to be very nutritious and tasty because of the climate, soil and organic fertilizer of hills. Clinical tests have proved that Mandua has rich quantity of Calcium, Phosphorus, Iron and Vitamins. It contains other natural minerals also which are good for health. Because of its nutritional properties Manduwa became part of daily used food of the people of Uttarakhand.

It was being cooked as a whole or mixing with the floor of wheat. It's test increases when taking with clarified butter, jaggery, buttermilk and other green vegetables. Many traditional snacks are also prepared with the floor of Mandua which includes Seede, Dendke, Palyo and Litua. A cooked liquid form of Mandua is traditionally being used to give ladies after their delivery of child. In rural areas farmers give its liquid cooked soup to their live stocks when they fall ill. Due to the richness of natural minerals and vitamins in Mandua, its demand is increasing continuously not only in the country but also in abroad from last few years.



> The traditional millet which is produced in state is full with health benefits and through the promotion of these grains, the income of farmers will also increase. Our government is working for use and production of millets. Keeping this in mind union government has given the permission for procurement of Mandua.
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> *— Pushkar Singh Dhami*
> *Chief Minister, Uttarakhand*

INCOME OF FARMERS WILL INCREASE

In India, Uttarakhand is the third largest producer of Mandua after Karnataka and Maharashtra. Keeping in mind the huge demand for Mandua at national and international level, the Uttrakhand government is trying to promote the cultivation of Mandua in state. The cluster based agriculture production scheme has been initiated in this regard and the local farmers are expecting the growth in there income through this scheme.

STATE IS PREPARING MILLET CALENDAR

The millets being produced in state are full of vitamins and minerals and its promotion will definitely help farmers in increasing their income. Therefore the state government is preparing the annual calendar of millets under the millet mission along with promoting the products made from millets.

The plan is to organise millet conferences and providing millet recipes to hotels and restaurants in all development blocks of the state, along with organising workshops across the state for women self help groups. State government is also planning to organised millet melas and conferences with the help of 515 multipurpose cooperative societies in hilly districts for the promotion of Mandua and Jhangora.

ATTRACTIVE PRODUCTS OF MILLETS

The production of burfi and biscuits from the floor of Mandua has already started in Uttarakhand. It is clear that there is a growing demand for millets like Mandua in Uttarakhand and it is also increasing the income of farmers. The market for Mandua has grown up in recent times. People are preparing the Barfi made of Mandua in Tehri Garhwal district. While families of 20 villages including monar village in Bageshwar district are preparing biscuits from the flour of Mandua.

This biscuit will be launched in market with the brand name of Hilaans. A team of union government officials has also visited and inspected the products being made in Monar village.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has already praised Mandua in his program Man ki Baat. The people of the region are also very excited and say that if there will be employment avenues available at local level then it will definitely curb the migration.

It is being said that with the help of cooperative sector more than 5 lakh rupees can be earned every year through this initiative. People are also preparing the biscuits of Maze and Chaulai along with Mandua in the region.

ENCOURAGING THE FARMING OF MANDUA

State government is also working to promote the farming of millets. Farming of Mandua is going at large scale in Bageshwar district. Along with that some clusters are also being developed and seeds have been distributed among farmers.

Farmers in hilly districts are traditionally producing Mandua and Marcha, now the government is planning to double their production. Central government is also supporting the projects of state government and expert say that it will not only stop the migration but will also provide employment at local level.